

EVOLSPHERE EDITIONS

TOME 1

RUPTURES 2027

Wars, energy, climate, elections, AI and robotics: what will reshape 2027

FREE

An Evolsphere Editions Tome, published on the 1st of every month

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The essentials, in one page

- Wars — On February 28, 2026, a US-Israeli operation against Iran killed Supreme Leader Khamenei and triggered the most intense conflict in the Middle East since 1948, closing the Strait of Hormuz. A peace deal followed on June 15, but lasting effects are expected.
- Energy — Oil prices topped \$115 per barrel at the peak of the crisis (+60 to 70% in seven weeks). Experts rule out a return below \$80 by the end of 2026. Post-2022 diversification limited but did not remove Europe's exposure.
- Critical resources — China restricted exports of 7 rare earth minerals; the IEA estimates \$6.5 trillion of global downstream industrial output at risk if fully enforced, including \$4.2 trillion for IEA countries alone.
- Climate — Summer 2026 is officially France's hottest ever recorded: 52-53 days of heatwave, over 100,000 hectares burned, more than 7,300 excess deaths, -0.1 GDP point. The ECB and Banque de France now classify heatwaves as a systemic risk.
- French election — Vote on April 18 and May 2, 2027, over 30 potential candidates, a fragmented right, a left running two separate primaries, judicial uncertainty around Marine Le Pen.
- US midterms — Vote on November 3, 2026. House favors Democrats (a net gain of 3 seats suffices), Senate favors Republicans: a divided government is the most likely outcome.
- AI and robotics — In one year, Beijing's World Humanoid Robot Games grew from 280 to 666 teams, with performances doubling or tripling (100m: 21.5s → 8.6s). A robot beat Usain Bolt's world record.
- What this changes — None of these disruptions fit into a standard annual planning calendar. The common factor among organizations that navigated 2026 best: continuously available leadership, not an engagement that stops at the first surprise.

Foreword

This Tome does not aim to predict the future — no one seriously can. It aims to lay out, with verified figures rather than impressions, the disruptions already underway that will shape 2027: active wars reshaping energy flows, a climate that has become a structural economic variable, two major electoral deadlines (France, United States), and a pace of technological acceleration whose speed, more than the level reached, should command the attention of any organization.

Each chapter ends with a simple question: what does this concretely change for a company, a team, a project? That is the thread running through the Evolsphere Editions collection — and the natural bridge to the support Evolsphere provides day to day.

1. Wars and geopolitical realignment

1.1 The turning point of February 28, 2026

On February 28, 2026, the United States and Israel launched a large-scale military operation against Iran, causing the death of Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei within days and triggering the most intense conflict the Middle East had seen since 1948. The succession was immediate: Mojtaba Khamenei was named the new Supreme Leader within twenty-four hours, demonstrating the regime's capacity to absorb a shock that many observers had judged potentially destabilizing for the entire state apparatus rather than collapse under it.

This point deserves emphasis: a significant share of Western analysis had bet on lasting fragility for the Iranian regime after the disappearance of its historic Supreme Leader. The speed and orderliness of the succession showed the opposite — an institutional resilience that surprised even the best-informed intelligence services.

1.2 The rapid expansion of the conflict

Iran's response took the form of a de facto closure of the Strait of Hormuz — a 33-kilometer corridor through which roughly 20% of the world's oil and a quarter of its liquefied natural gas transit. According to the International Energy Agency, this represents the most significant disruption to oil supply in the history of the market. The agency's executive director warned as early as March 21 that a prolonged closure of the strait was "the greatest threat to global energy security in history."

The conflict was not confined to a bilateral confrontation. Lebanon entered the war on March 2, the Gulf monarchies — Kuwait, Qatar, Bahrain, Oman, the United Arab Emirates — were all directly affected by regional spillover, and Yemen's Houthis reopened a second front in the Red Sea as early as February 28, forcing a significant share of global maritime traffic to reroute around Africa via the Cape of Good Hope rather than through the Suez Canal. This detour mechanically extended transport times and raised logistics costs on major global trade routes, well beyond the region itself.

Eighteen civilian vessels were attacked in the Gulf during the first month of the conflict. More than 40 energy facilities suffered significant damage, placing several regional producers in a position of force majeure toward their international customers — a contractual clause rarely invoked at this scale in recent industry history.

1.3 A fragile ceasefire, not a resolution

A two-week truce was declared on April 7, followed by a peace agreement announced on June 15 aiming to progressively reopen the strait. "Let the oil flow!" Donald Trump summed up upon the announcement — triggering an immediate drop of more than 4% in the price of oil. But the announcement did not signal a return to normal: the real points of contention between Washington and Tehran were pushed to a further sixty days of negotiation, and industry experts estimate it will take several months to restore maritime traffic comparable to pre-war levels, if only because of the dozens of damaged facilities and maritime insurance premiums that remain at deterrent levels for many shipowners.

1.4 Ukraine, in the background

While global attention focused on the Gulf, the war in Ukraine continued with no serious prospect of a negotiated resolution. Russia showed no willingness to engage in direct talks with Kyiv, and its demands remained incompatible with Ukraine's red lines. The conflict slid into a pattern of prolonged attrition — drones and missiles exchanged at a high rate, deep strikes notably targeting energy infrastructure on both sides — rather than toward a decisive military outcome for either side. Ukrainian forces nonetheless reclaimed more than 100 km² of territory in April 2026, a sign of relative front-line stabilization rather than a collapse of either party.

European support for Ukraine strengthened as direct American engagement was recalibrated, without the feared spillover of the conflict into NATO member states materializing. The NATO summit on July 7-8, 2026 in Turkey crystallized an underlying debate, potentially more structurally significant in the medium term than the conflict itself: Europe, lacking a defense industry able to meet Kyiv's needs alone in volume and timing, finds itself effectively financing American arms purchases rather than rebuilding production autonomy. Washington presents this model as virtuous for the collective effort; it raises, in the background, questions about the real degree of strategic autonomy the continent can achieve by 2027.

1.5 Scenarios for 2027

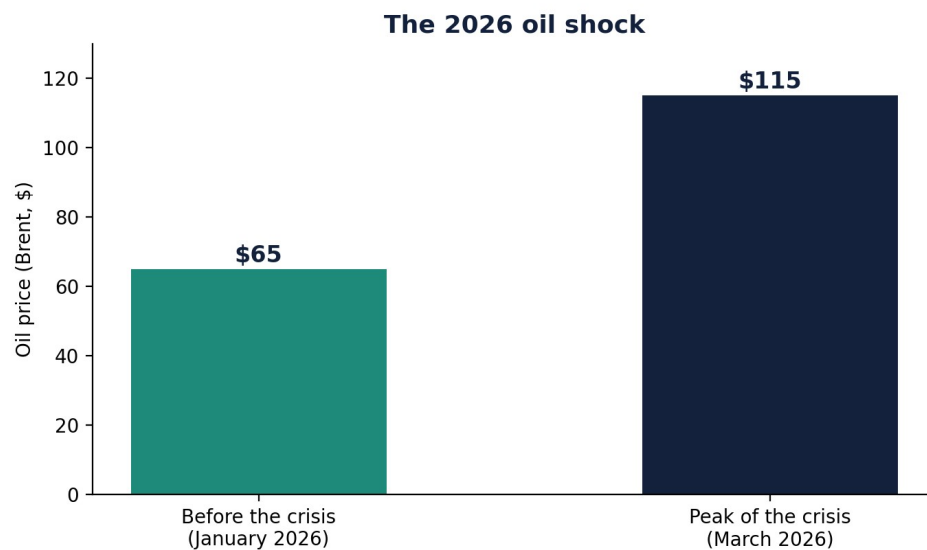
Three trajectories are emerging for the coming year. The first is continued containment without resolution on both fronts: neither the war in Ukraine nor the Middle East situation finds a lasting negotiated outcome, but neither degenerates into an openly expanded conflict either — the scenario judged most likely today by most analysts consulted. The second is a resumption of hostilities at Hormuz should the sixty-day negotiations launched in June fail, with a fresh energy shock during the year. The third, more optimistic but currently less likely, would see a gradual normalization on both fronts allow a lasting pullback in energy prices.

What this changes for organizations

- A country-risk map fixed once a year is no longer sufficient: two major, simultaneous crises on two different theaters broke out within a single year, 2026.
- Organizations whose supply chains, travel, or partnerships cross these regions had to arbitrate under pressure, without the usual time for deliberation.
- The force majeure clause, invoked at scale by several energy producers in 2026, is worth revisiting in critical supply contracts — its wording, often inherited from a more stable context, did not anticipate this type of scenario.

2. Energy and dependencies

2.1 The scale of the oil shock



The closure of the Strait of Hormuz sent crude prices up nearly 60% for the WTI index and over 70% for Brent within seven weeks, with a barrel exceeding \$115 at the height of the crisis — a swing comparable in brutality to the historic oil shocks of 1973 and 1979, as several industry analysts noted at the time. Despite the June peace deal and the easing that followed, experts consider a return below \$80 per barrel unlikely by the end of 2026, even with a lasting agreement between Washington and Tehran — the damage to infrastructure and the loss of confidence in the stability of the Hormuz route producing effects that outlast the military conflict itself.

2.2 A diversified dependency is still a dependency

For Europe, the shock was less direct than in 2022 — dependency on Gulf energy supply having already been reduced since the Ukraine crisis — but no less revealing at its core. Diversification undertaken since 2022 changed the geography of dependency without removing it: for oil, Europe's main current partners are the United States, Norway and Kazakhstan; for gas, Norway holds a central position, followed by Algeria and the United Kingdom; for liquefied natural gas, the United States dominates by far, ahead of Russia and then Qatar.

This diversification reduced certain one-off risks but did not remove the structural dependency: Europe remains deeply embedded in a global market where prices react immediately to geopolitical tensions, wherever they arise on the planet. The central lesson of the 2026 crisis, in the words of several energy economists, is therefore not that further diversification is needed — that is already well underway — but that dependency on imported hydrocarbons remains, whatever the geography of suppliers, a first-order geopolitical vulnerability.

2.3 A global reconfiguration of investment

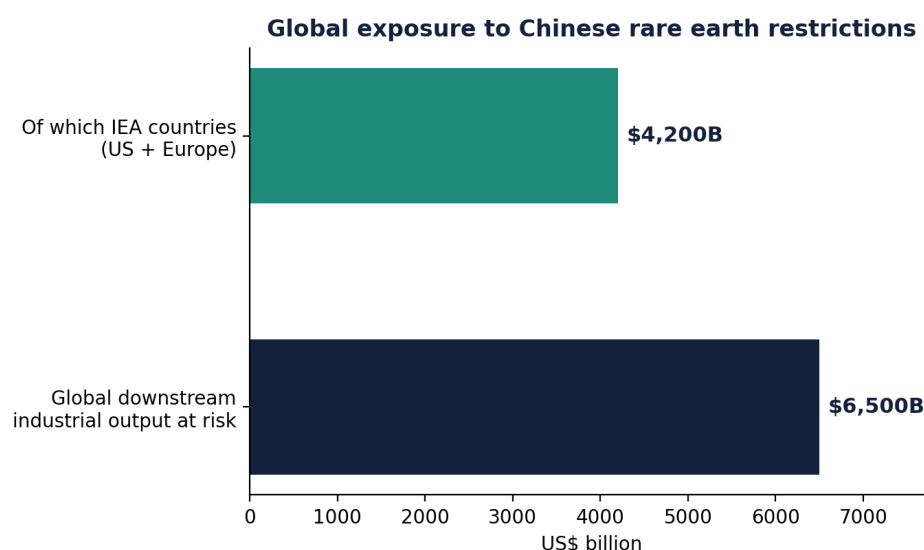
According to the IEA's World Energy Investment 2026 report, the crisis accelerated an already-underway reconfiguration of global energy investment, projected at \$3.4 trillion for the year. Oil investment fell for the third consecutive year, below \$500 billion, while gas investment reached \$330 billion — its highest level in ten years — driven by new liquefied natural gas projects in the United States and Qatar. Coal investment also rose, a sign the crisis did not mechanically accelerate the energy transition across the board: some states instead reactivated carbon-based capacity to secure short-term supply.

2.4 The French case

France, thanks to diversification undertaken after the 2022 crisis, shows lower direct dependency on the Gulf and the Strait of Hormuz than several of its European neighbors. But the country remains indirectly exposed, through global market prices for oil and gas that know no national borders — a rise in Brent affects pump prices

and French industrial costs at the same pace as elsewhere in Europe, regardless of the actual geographic origin of the barrel consumed.

2.5 Rare earths and semiconductors: the other critical dependency



Oil and gas are not the only resources whose geopolitics hardened in 2026. China announced export restrictions on seven rare earth minerals to all countries, with some limitations temporarily suspended until the end of 2026 — a deliberately flexible structure that keeps a rapidly activatable pressure lever in place. These materials are essential to sectors ranging from electric vehicles to defense, as well as the advanced semiconductors used notably for artificial intelligence.

According to the IEA's Global Critical Minerals Outlook 2026, full enforcement of these Chinese restrictions could threaten up to \$6.5 trillion of downstream industrial production outside China, of which roughly \$4.2 trillion is concentrated in IEA member countries alone — essentially the United States and Europe. Rare earth prices have already risen 30% since the start of 2026 according to several sector analysts, and global demand could triple by 2030 under the combined effect of the energy transition and AI-driven semiconductor demand.

Meeting in Paris in early May 2026, G7 ministers officially acknowledged for the first time, without directly naming Beijing, a situation of critical Western dependency on China for these materials — a dependency that goes beyond mining extraction and mainly concerns refining and processing capacity, overwhelmingly concentrated in China even when the raw ore is mined elsewhere. In response, the US administration announced as early as February 2026 the creation of a \$12 billion strategic rare earth reserve, while the European Union is accelerating its Critical Raw Materials regulation (strategic stockpiles, simplified procedures for mining projects). These initiatives will nonetheless remain limited in the short term: opening a mine or a refining plant structurally takes more than ten years, a timeline that far exceeds the 2027 horizon covered by this Tome.

2.6 The special case of French electricity

Unlike oil and gas, France's electricity supply was not directly affected by the Gulf crisis, the national electricity mix relying mainly on nuclear and, to a lesser extent, hydropower — two sources unconnected to Middle Eastern shipping routes. This specificity partly insulated France from the most direct shock, without however protecting it from indirect effects on industrial costs linked to imported gas and oil, nor from summer grid strain caused by the heatwaves described in the next chapter. The combination of an external energy shock and an internal climate shock occurring in the same year illustrates the need to think about energy resilience holistically rather than one risk vector at a time.

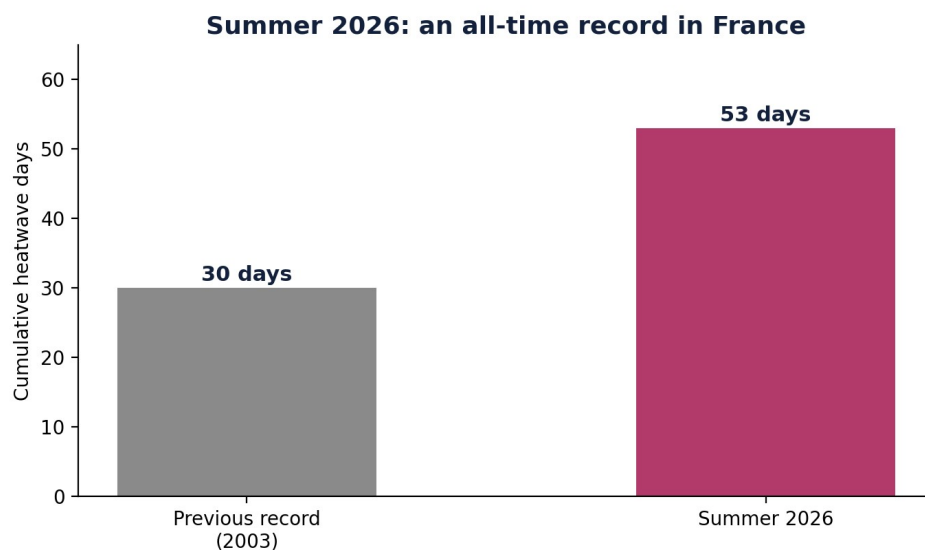
What this changes for organizations

- Diversifying suppliers remains necessary but is no longer sufficient on its own: it changes the geography of risk, not its existence.

- Companies whose production or transport costs are sensitive to energy prices should model scenarios of sustained high prices (above \$80 per barrel), not just one-off spikes expected to quickly recede.
- The most significant feature of the 2026 shock is its announced persistence beyond the resolution of the conflict that triggered it — a point of vigilance for any 12-18 month budget forecast.
- Any organization dependent on electronic components, electric vehicles, or systems incorporating permanent magnets should map its real exposure to Chinese rare earths — often invisible because it sits with a tier-2 or tier-3 supplier, not the direct one.

3. Climate: an economic variable, not just an environmental issue

3.1 An extraordinary summer, in numbers



Summer 2026 will go down in the record books: Météo-France officially designated it France's hottest summer ever recorded, with an average temperature of 16.5°C over the period, nearly half a degree above the previous record. June 24, 2026 became the hottest day ever measured in mainland France, with a national average temperature of 29.9°C combining day and night — the previous record, 29.4°C, had stood since 2019. The following day, 72 départements were placed under red heatwave alert, an unprecedented mobilization level since the warning system was created.

The country accumulated 52 to 53 days of heatwave since mid-June, a historic record, with a sixteen-day consecutive sequence in early July ranking among the longest ever recorded. A fourth heatwave episode began on July 28 (40.2°C in Tarbes, 41°C in Bergerac, 40.7°C in Angoulême and Bordeaux), followed by a fifth wave announced for early August — the season was, by mid-year, not yet over.

3.2 A bill spread across several categories

More than 100,000 hectares burned over the summer according to the European Effis system, a level not seen in twenty years, with losses already estimated at €500 million by France Assureurs for fires alone — a first assessment the industry federation itself describes as provisional, the real scale of economic and material damage likely being higher once all assessments are completed.

On the health front, Santé publique France recorded more than 7,300 excess deaths since the start of summer (5,764 between June 17-30, 1,243 between July 3-22, 300 as early as May), for a total social cost — care, lost productivity, years of life lost — estimated at more than €500 million by health economists. Southern France concentrates the most severe impacts, deepening territorial inequalities already documented during previous heatwaves.

The agricultural sector was also hit hard: the late-June heatwave caused animal mortality to jump 1,000% in poultry and 200% in pigs according to a national rendering company, and a third of farmers insured against climate multi-risk filed a claim over the period. The Ministry of Agriculture had to release Bpifrance-guaranteed cash loans to finance the equipping of livestock buildings with misting and ventilation.

3.3 A change in the status of climate risk

A sign that the issue has changed in nature in the eyes of financial institutions: the Banque de France and the European Central Bank now classify heatwaves as a systemic risk and a structural economic variable, on par with an interest-rate or commodity shock — not as a one-off weather event to set aside from macroeconomic analysis. The Ministry of Economy estimated the combined impact of heatwaves and drought at 0.1 GDP point for France in 2026, mainly driven by the drop in agricultural output, but also spreading via energy, public health, and overall labor productivity.

What this changes for organizations

- Climate is no longer a corporate social responsibility topic to be handled separately: it is now a direct cost factor (insurance, energy, productivity) and a business continuity issue on par with a major IT outage.
- Organizations that have not tested their operational resilience to prolonged heat episodes — buildings, supply chains, workforce, cold chain — discover this risk as it materializes rather than beforehand, which structurally costs more than advance preparation.
- Climate multi-risk insurance clauses are worth revisiting in light of 2026 claims: several lines of business (livestock notably) saw their coverage terms evolve during the year under the effect of claims volume.

4. The 2027 French presidential election

4.1 A fixed calendar, an uncertain field

The vote is set for April 18 and May 2, 2027. A year before the deadline, France's political landscape shows unprecedented fragmentation under the Fifth Republic: more than thirty potential candidates are declared or expected at this stage, a figure that reflects less a healthy democratic abundance than a structural difficulty for traditional political families to produce a single candidate able to unite their camp.

4.2 A divided right, a left with two primaries

The right remains divided between several competing poles, with no leader yet emerging as a natural unifying candidate. The left, for its part, is running two separate primaries rather than a single candidacy — a configuration that, if it persists through the vote, would mechanically reduce each bloc's chances of reaching the runoff, following a pattern of fragmentation already seen in previous elections.

4.3 The judicial unknown

Marine Le Pen's judicial situation — convicted on appeal, with a cassation appeal underway — adds further uncertainty to the actual shape of the first round. Still eligible pending the cassation ruling, her candidacy remains a variable capable of reshuffling the balance of power until a late stage of the electoral calendar.

4.4 The weight of abstention and local realignments

Beyond the national picture, the intermediate elections held since 2022 have shown structurally high abstention and rapid local realignments, sometimes with no direct link to candidates' national labels. This electorate volatility, combined with the fragmentation of political supply noted above, makes electoral forecasting a year out particularly perilous — polling institutes themselves stressing the unusual margin of uncertainty in their projections at this stage of the cycle.

What this changes for organizations

- Such high political uncertainty a year before the vote complicates any multi-year planning exercise sensitive to French fiscal, regulatory, or industrial policy.
- Organizations whose investment decisions depend on these parameters benefit from thinking in multiple scenarios rather than a single hypothesis for 2027, current fragmentation making a consensus reading of the outcome unlikely before the first round itself.
- Sectors directly exposed to budgetary and fiscal decisions (capital taxation, payroll charges, public procurement) benefit from preparing several trajectory scenarios rather than locking in a single plan before spring 2027.

5. US midterms — November 3, 2026

5.1 What's at stake

All 435 seats of the House of Representatives and roughly a third of Senate seats will be renewed on November 3, 2026. This mid-term vote historically functions as a sanction or confirmation of the sitting executive — without ever mechanically guaranteeing the continuation of the existing balance of power.

5.2 Current projections

Available projections at this stage put Democrats as statistical favorites to retake control of the House of Representatives: a net gain of just three seats would suffice to flip the majority, a threshold considered attainable given the historical trend of midterm elections generally being unfavorable to the sitting president's party. In the Senate, however, Republicans remain favored to keep their majority, this year's map of seats up for renewal being structurally more favorable to them than to Democrats.

5.3 The divided government scenario

The most likely scenario at this stage is therefore a divided government in Washington — a Democratic House facing a Republican Senate and executive. This type of configuration structurally limits the administration's ability to pass major new legislation, while leaving intact trade and regulatory levers that do not require a legislative vote.

5.4 A historical precedent, with nuance

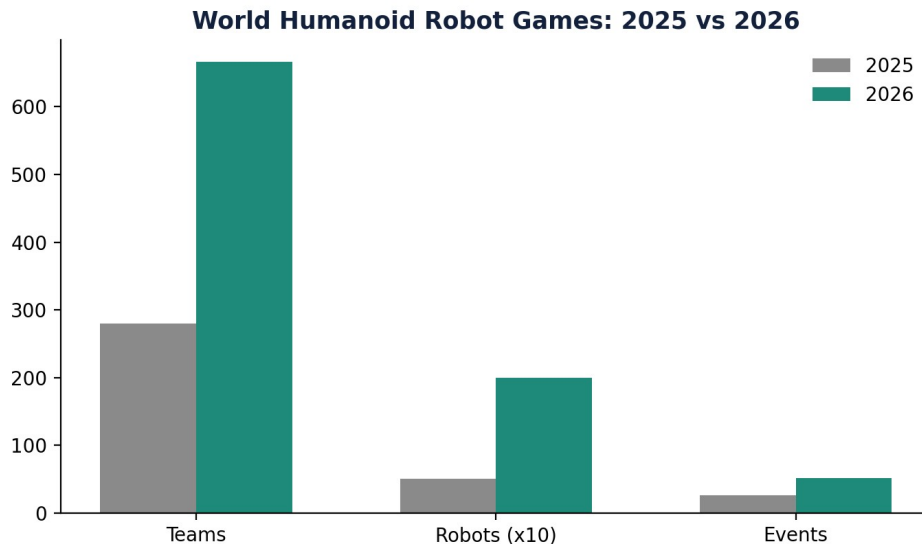
Midterm elections have statistically sanctioned the sitting president's party for several decades — but the scale of that sanction varies significantly with the economic and international context of the moment. The year 2026, marked by an energy shock and inflation imported via the Gulf crisis, could amplify this sanction dynamic rather than soften it, American voters historically being sensitive to gas prices at the pump when voting.

What this changes for organizations

- A divided Congress changes the dynamics of any US trade or regulatory policy dependent on a legislative vote — tariff packages requiring ratification, tax reform, the federal budget.
- Companies exposed to the US market benefit from anticipating a more likely legislative gridlock than a full policy reversal, and from distinguishing executive decisions (less affected by Congress's configuration) from reforms requiring a vote.
- The risk of a federal budget shutdown increases mechanically with a divided Congress — a factor to factor in for any activity dependent on US federal contracts or authorizations.

6. The acceleration of AI and robotics: the Chinese case, in numbers

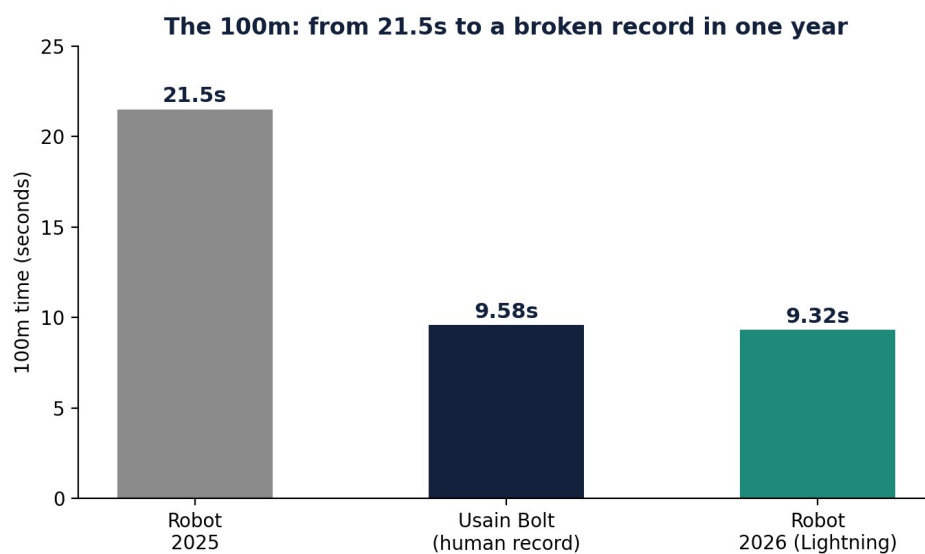
6.1 A sporting competition as a revealing indicator



The year's most telling comparison does not come from a research lab but from a sports competition: Beijing's World Humanoid Robot Games, held in 2025 and again in 2026. The event's very format makes it a particularly readable indicator, as it measures directly comparable physical performance from one edition to the next, without the hype that often accompanies AI research publications.

In one year, the number of participating teams rose from 280 to 666, more than doubling. The number of robots entered rose from around 500 to more than 2,000, and the number of events from 26 to 51 — an expansion reflecting massive and rapid investment in China's robotics ecosystem, beyond the already well-known players.

6.2 Performances beyond the usual human scale



Measured performances improved by margins far exceeding what is typically observed in human sport, where records usually advance by a few percentage points per Olympic cycle. The 100 meters went from 21.5 seconds in 2025 to roughly 8.6-8.9 seconds in 2026 depending on the source; the standing high jump from 0.95-0.96

meters to 3.4 meters; the standing long jump from 1.25-1.47 meters to 4.83 meters. A robot built by manufacturer Honor, nicknamed "Lightning," even beat Usain Bolt's human world record for the 100 meters (9.58 seconds), clocking 9.32 seconds — a result that, for the first time in this type of competition, places a machine above the best human performance ever recorded over that distance.

6.3 From sport to real economic use

The most important signal for an organization is not the level reached in absolute terms, but the speed at which it was reached — a doubling of performance in a single year, on movements engaging an entire articulated body's kinematic chain, not just an isolated algorithm. The 2026 edition also changed the very nature of the events on offer: beyond classic sporting disciplines (running, jumping, gymnastics, martial arts), new scenario-based competitions now simulate real economic tasks — hotel service, cleaning, emergency rescue — a sign that the ultimate goal of these competitions goes beyond pure technological demonstration toward use cases directly transferable to existing jobs.

This shift is consistent with a separate but concurrent announcement: in March 2025, China set up a 1 trillion yuan fund dedicated to technology start-ups, explicitly including robotics and artificial intelligence among priority funding sectors — a public capital allocation choice that, a year later, finds a concrete and measurable expression in this competition's results.

6.4 And on the generative AI side?

Humanoid robotics is only the most spectacular part of a broader acceleration. On the software side alone, enterprise adoption of generative AI continued its rapid progression begun since 2023, with a notable shift observed in 2026: the question is no longer whether an organization should adopt AI, but how it supervises uses already widespread, often informally, within its teams. It is precisely this shift — from adoption to supervision — that structures the entire Evolsphere Editions collection and the support Evolsphere provides: AI without methodological supervision amplifies existing organizational errors at least as fast as it amplifies performance.

What this changes for organizations

- Such rapid progress over a one-year cycle suggests that 3-5 year planning assumptions about the automation of physical tasks deserve to be revised upward in terms of arrival speed, regardless of industry.
- The shift of competitions toward real-use scenarios (hospitality, cleaning, rescue) is the signal to watch closely for any sector employing labor on repetitive or standardizable physical tasks.
- The availability of massive public capital in this sector in China changes the competitive landscape for any Western company positioned, even indirectly, in markets adjacent to service robotics.

Timeline 2026-2027

Date	Event
Feb 28, 2026	Start of the US-Israeli-Iranian conflict, closure of the Strait of Hormuz.
April 7, 2026	Two-week truce in the Middle East.
May 2026	G7 in Paris: official acknowledgment of dependency on Chinese rare earths.
June 15, 2026	Iran/US peace agreement, progressive reopening of the Strait of Hormuz.
Jul 7-8, 2026	NATO summit in Turkey — debate on European defense autonomy.
Nov 3, 2026	US midterms — House and one-third of the Senate renewed.
Apr 18 / May 2, 2027	French presidential election, two rounds.

Impacts by domain

Domain	Direct impact	Most exposed organizations
Wars / Hormuz	Maritime and logistics risk, rising insurance premiums.	Import-export, maritime transport, energy.
Energy	Sustainably higher production and transport costs.	Energy-intensive industry, transport, agriculture.
Rare earths	Invisible tier-2/3 supplier risk, price pressure.	Electronics, electric vehicles, defense.
Climate	Insurance costs, production losses, business interruption.	Agriculture, construction, tourism, healthcare.
FR/US elections	Heightened fiscal and regulatory uncertainty.	Any organization investing through 2027.
AI/robotics	Acceleration of physical and administrative task automation.	Industry, logistics, administrative services.

Opportunities

- Revisit critical supply contracts (energy, rare earths) while the topic is still high on your suppliers' agenda — renegotiated clauses now cost less than after the next shock.
- Anticipate demand linked to climate resilience (parametric insurance, cooling equipment, building adaptation) before demand saturates available supply.
- Invest in automating standardizable tasks before competitors, often Chinese in robotics, gain a lasting lead.
- Use the electoral uncertainty period (France, United States) to prepare several budget scenarios rather than waiting for clarity that won't arrive for months.

Recommendations and action plan

Three priorities, regardless of your size

- Revisit your energy cost and logistics delay assumptions for 2027 in light of chapter 2 — not simply roll over last year's budget.
- Map your indirect exposure to Chinese rare earths and semiconductors, often invisible at a tier-2 or tier-3 supplier.
- Test your organization's operational resilience to a prolonged heat episode, before it recurs next summer.

Which support formula fits your situation

Your situation	What you need	Evalsphere plan
Small structure exposed to a single one of these risks	A monthly check-in to track the topic and adjust if needed.	Essential — €1,490 excl. VAT/month
SME exposed to several of these disruptions at once	Regular leadership to arbitrate priorities and track several risks at once.	Steering — €2,490 excl. VAT/month
Organization whose strategy heavily depends on the geopolitical context	Near-continuous availability to adjust course at the real pace of events.	Outsourced Leadership — €4,490 excl. VAT/month

Each plan includes a first 30-to-60-minute call to assess, with no commitment, which one truly fits your situation — write to us at evolsphere.com.

7. Synthesis: what these disruptions change for your organization

7.1 A common thread behind six disparate topics

These six chapters appear, on the surface, to have nothing in common: a war in the Middle East, an energy shock, a record-breaking summer, two elections on two continents, a robot competition. The thread connecting them is this: in each case, the speed at which the situation changed exceeded the speed at which the organizations concerned could adapt through their usual decision-making processes.

A strategic plan built in January 2026 overwhelmingly did not account for a US-Israeli-Iranian war starting on February 28, a summer that would break every heat record, or such a sharp acceleration in Chinese robotics. This is not a criticism of planning teams — it is an observation about the very nature of forecasting in an environment of this volatility.

7.2 What AI alone does not solve

This is precisely the blind spot that neither an artificial intelligence tool nor a fixed strategic plan can fill alone. An AI model, however powerful, amplifies the execution of decisions already made or automates already-framed tasks — it does not, on its own, arbitrate the uncertainty of a conflict starting on February 28 or that of an election fragmented across thirty candidates. An annual plan sets a direction and a budget trajectory, but by construction does not structurally anticipate the unexpected, unless it builds in margins that often remain theoretical until tested under real conditions.

What made the difference, among organizations that navigated these disruptions best in 2026, was the presence of leadership able to stay in touch with the real pace of events — not just the calendar set at the start of the year. This does not mean reacting on the fly without method: it means having, continuously, an up-to-date view of

what has changed and what it concretely implies, rather than rediscovering the scale of a shock at the next quarterly review.

7.3 A reading matrix for 2027

Cross-referencing the six chapters, three zones of vigilance emerge for the year ahead. The first concerns direct exposure to conflict zones and energy prices — relevant to any organization whose logistics or industrial costs are sensitive to oil prices. The second concerns operational resilience to climate extremes — relevant to any organization with physical assets, supply chains, or a workforce exposed to heat. The third concerns the speed of automation of physical tasks — relevant to any organization employing labor on standardizable tasks, regardless of sector.

The two electoral deadlines (France 2027, US midterms 2026) do not, strictly speaking, constitute a fourth, distinct zone of vigilance: they instead act as an uncertainty multiplier on the first three, by potentially changing the fiscal, regulatory, and trade rules within which these risks materialize.

7.4 What Evolsphere offers

This is the entire purpose of the support Evolsphere provides: availability and a follow-up rhythm, not an engagement that stops the moment the unexpected begins. A monthly leadership subscription, structured around availability rather than billed days, is precisely what allows this contact with the real pace of events to be maintained — even as that pace changes over the course of a year, as 2026 clearly demonstrated.

Sources and method

This Tome draws on public sources verified at the time of writing (International Energy Agency, Météo-France, Santé publique France, Ministry of Economy, Ministry of Agriculture, specialized geopolitical and economic press). Figures relating to still-evolving events — peace agreements, ongoing negotiations, electoral projections — are subject to revision; they reflect the state of available information as of the publication date indicated on the last page.

Evolsphere Editions claims no exclusivity over this data: the collection's purpose is to gather it, connect it, and draw directly usable operational implications from it — not to produce novel information in the journalistic sense.

In upcoming Tomes

The Evolsphere Editions collection continues with a new Tome on the 1st of every month. Two themes already underway for upcoming issues, directly building on the topics covered here:

Demographics and work: the shortage ahead

Aging of the European workforce, waves of retirements across entire segments of independent retail and craft trades, sector-specific labor shortages, and automation — of which chapter 6 of this Tome gives a concrete preview — as a structural rather than one-off response.

The end of fast fashion: new consumption, secondhand, and selective retail

A fast-growing secondhand market, rising distrust of ultra-fast fashion, and what these two movements concretely change for retail — a topic where direct operational experience usefully complements macroeconomic analysis.

About Evolsphere Editions

E volsphere Editions is the Tome collection published by Evolsphere, built on a simple conviction: artificial intelligence is necessary for every organization today, but it is not sufficient without methodological supervision and an up-to-date reading of the context in which it operates. The collection currently includes two catalogues (ten Tomes) on corporate strategy, organizational transformation, and augmented growth, available for one-off purchase at evolsphere.com.

This Tome 1, "RUPTURES 2027," launches a different, complementary format: a geopolitical, economic and technological news analysis, published on the 1st of every month, available by annual subscription under the name "Vision 2030 Subscription." It is offered free of charge so anyone can assess its relevance before subscribing.

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